# Community Services and Public Safety Committee Meeting
## Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers
100 Ribaut Road,
Beaufort, SC 29902

**Tuesday, February 3, 2026**
**2:00 PM**

**MINUTES**

***Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting*** https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/373887

**1. Call to Order**

Committee Vice-Chair Reitz called the meeting to order at 2:00 PM

**Present**
Committee Chair David Bartholomew - Virtual
Committee Vice-Chair Thomas Reitz
Committee Member York Glover
Committee Member Lawrence McElynn
Committee Member Anna Maria Tabernik - Virtual
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member Joseph Passiment

**Absent**
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Mark Lawson

**2. Pledge of Allegiance**

Committee Vice-Chair Reitz led the Pledge of Allegiance.

**3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA**

Committee Vice-Chair Reitz stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

**4. Approval of Agenda**

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the agenda.

**Motion to Amend:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member McElynn to amend the agenda to take item 8.b and move it to be item 9.b.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion to amend passed 8:0.

**Main Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the agenda as amended.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment. The main motion passed 8:0.

**5. Approval of Minutes**

**Motion:** It was moved by Ex-Officio Howard, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the minutes from November 3, 2026.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 8:0.

**6. Public Comment Period**

Public comments were taken.

**7. Assistant County Administrators Report**

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
**https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/373887**

**8. Discussion/Presentation Items**

a. Discussion and Presentation of a Hate Crime Ordinance - Risa Prince, Lowcountry Coalition Against Hate

**Motion:** It was moved by Committee Member McElynn, seconded by Council Member Dawson to recommend we forward this to Council for full consideration of moving forward by directing the County Administrator and County Attorney to come forward with a hate intimidation bill that mirrors the one that has been produced by Richland County.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 8:0.

**9. Agenda Items**

a. An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain expectations and limitations thereto. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - County Attorney Brian Hulbert

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Ex-Officio Howard to approve an Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain expectations and limitations thereto.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member

Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Committee Chair Bartholomew and Committee Vice-Chair Reitz. The motion passed 6:2.

b. Approval of Mid-year budget amendment for Beaufort Water Search & Rescue - Patrick Canning, Beaufort Water Search and Rescue

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member McElynn to recommend we forward this to Council for full consideration by directing administration to take a look at the budget and identify an account or accounts that could be modified to meet the amount of money discussed.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 8:0.

**10. Adjournment**

Ratified: March 2, 2026